



# MarkingForge

Preset packs - ready-made dials for modelling, animation, look-dev and archviz

3DS MAX 2027 · VERSION 1.5.10

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Four sets of dials for one kind of work each. A pack replaces only the dials it names and leaves the rest of your layout as it is. Load one, try it for a day, keep what works - or take a single dial of a pack from the dial library.

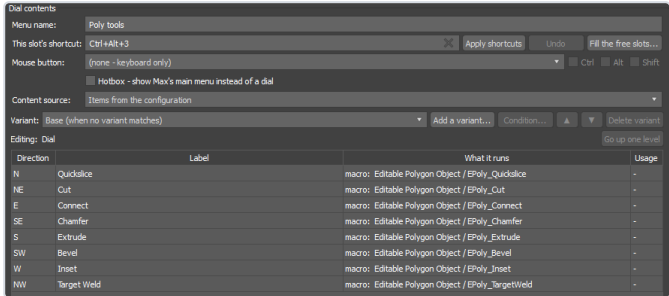
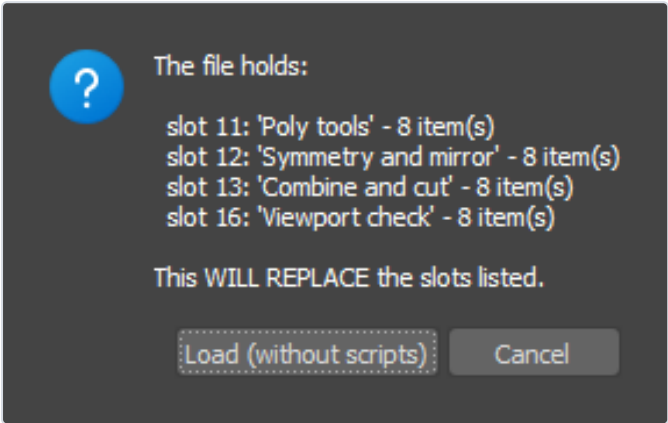
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# Loading a pack

- 1 Open **MarkingForge > Menu editor...**
- 2 Press **Load preset...** at the bottom and open a file from the **Presets** folder of the download.
- 3 The editor lists the dials the pack replaces - read it and press **Load (without scripts)**; the packs have none.
- 4 Look at the dials in the editor, then press **Save**. The dials change at once - no restart.



After loading: dial 11 is now Poly tools.

Before loading: the dials the Modelling pack will replace.

**Want your dials back?** Before saving: **Reload from file** throws the pack away. After saving, one dial at a time: **Dial library... > Built-in dials, as shipped > the dial (say Menu 11 - Show and hide) > Put on Menu 11**. All of them: **Load default dials...** (tick *Replace the slots that already have a menu as well*) restores the whole built-in layout. Or keep a copy of your own before trying a pack: **Save every dial...** (every dial with its sets and colours - **Load every dial...** puts it back) or **Save preset....**

The packs contain only 3ds Max commands - no scripts - so nothing is removed when they load, and every command was checked against a stock 2027 release of 3ds Max.

## One dial of a pack - the dial library

Every dial of the four packs is also a file of its own, in the editor's dial library and in **Dials\Packs** of the download. Take only the one you want, on any key:

- 1 Select the dial in the editor's list of dials and press **Dial library...** (or right-click the dial > **Put a dial from the library on Menu N...**).
- 2 Open *From the preset packs* and pick a dial - *Modelling: Poly tools*, say. Its drawing shows on the right.
- 3 **Put on Menu N** replaces what the dial shows (its key and mouse button stay). **Add as a new set of Menu N** keeps it: the key still opens what it opened, and the pack's dial is the next page - hold the key and turn the mouse wheel.
- 4 **Save**.

## The packs at a glance

| Pack                                                 | For                                                                                                                  | Replaces                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Modelling</b><br>MarkingForge_Pack_Modelling.json | Hard-surface and poly modelling: the poly tools on one key whatever the sub-object level, symmetry and mirror tools, | Poly tools (Ctrl+Alt+3, was: Show and hide), Symmetry and mirror (Ctrl+Alt+4, was: Viewports), Combine |

|                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                      | combining and cutting, and a viewport check dial.                                                                                                                                             | and cut (Ctrl+Alt+5, was: Viewport display), Viewport check (Ctrl+Alt+8, was: Render)                                                                                             |
| <b>Animation</b><br>MarkingForge_Pack_Animation.json | Keyframing: transform with the animation coordinate systems, every key command, playback and time, curves, tangents and layers - with Track View commands when the cursor is over Track View. | Animate transform (Ctrl+Alt+1, was: Transform), Keys (Ctrl+Alt+4, was: Viewports), Playback and time (Ctrl+Alt+8, was: Render), Curves and layers (Shift+Alt+2, was: Animation)   |
| <b>LookDev</b><br>MarkingForge_Pack_LookDev.json     | Look development: viewport shading and overrides, light display and shadows, camera controls.                                                                                                 | Shading (Ctrl+Alt+5, was: Viewport display), Lights (Shift+Alt+7, was: Tools and setup), Cameras (Shift+Alt+8, was: Lights and cameras)                                           |
| <b>Archviz</b><br>MarkingForge_Pack_Archviz.json     | Architectural visualisation and layout: placing, arraying and aligning, snaps, layers and groups, references and files.                                                                       | Place and array (Ctrl+Alt+1, was: Transform), Snaps (Ctrl+Alt+6, was: Snaps and grid), Layers and groups (Shift+Alt+3, was: Scene), References and files (Shift+Alt+4, was: File) |

# Modelling pack

Hard-surface and poly modelling: the poly tools on one key whatever the sub-object level, symmetry and mirror tools, combining and cutting, and a viewport check dial.

File: Presets\MarkingForge\_Pack\_Modelling.json

## Ctrl+Alt+3 Poly tools

dial 11 - replaces Show and hide

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Poly tools* - file Dials\Packs\Modelling - Poly tools.mfdial

|                   |                 |               |
|-------------------|-----------------|---------------|
| NW<br>Target Weld | N<br>Quickslice | NE<br>Cut     |
| W<br>Inset        | Poly tools      | E<br>Connect  |
| SW<br>Bevel       | S<br>Extrude    | SE<br>Chamfer |

List under the dial: Swift Loop · Remove Loop · Flow Connect · Distance Connect · Make planar · Tessellate · Hinge · Outline

## Ctrl+Alt+4 Symmetry and mirror

dial 12 - replaces Viewports

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Symmetry and mirror* - file Dials\Packs\Modelling - Symmetry and mirror.mfdial

|                |                     |                      |
|----------------|---------------------|----------------------|
| NW<br>+ Mirror | N<br>+ Symmetry     | NE<br>Symmetry tools |
| W<br>- to +    | Symmetry and mirror | E<br>+ to -          |
| SW<br>Copy     | S<br>Flip           | SE<br>Paste          |

List under the dial: Mirror element X · Mirror element Y · Mirror element Z · Symmetry select X · Mirror (object)...

## Ctrl+Alt+5 Combine and cut

dial 13 - replaces Viewport display

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Combine and cut* - file Dials\Packs\Modelling - Combine and cut.mfdial

|                   |                     |                  |
|-------------------|---------------------|------------------|
| NW<br>+ Cap Holes | N<br>ProCutter      | NE<br>ShapeMerge |
| W<br>+ Welder     | Combine and cut     | E<br>Connect     |
| SW<br>Snapshot... | S<br>Collapse stack | SE<br>Attach     |

List under the dial: Detach · + Vertex Weld · + Slice · + Chamfer

**Ctrl+Alt+8**

## Viewport check

dial 16 - replaces Render

Alone, from the dial library: *Modelling: Viewport check* - file `Dials\Packs\Modelling - Viewport check.mfdial`

|                                |                         |                          |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Zoom selected     | <b>N</b><br>Edged faces | <b>NE</b><br>See-through |
| <b>W</b><br>Wireframe / shaded | <b>Viewport check</b>   | <b>E</b><br>Statistics   |
| <b>SW</b><br>Backface cull     | <b>S</b><br>Isolate     | <b>SE</b><br>Edges only  |

**List under the dial:** Clay · Realistic with maps · Default shading · Wireframe · Vertex ticks

# Animation pack

Keyframing: transform with the animation coordinate systems, every key command, playback and time, curves, tangents and layers - with Track View commands when the cursor is over Track View.

File: Presets\MarkingForge\_Pack\_Animation.json

## Ctrl+Alt+1 Animate transform

dial 9 - replaces Transform

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Animate transform* - file Dials\Packs\Animation - Animate transform.mfdial

|                      |                       |                      |
|----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| NW<br>Coords: world  | N<br>Move             | NE<br>Rotate         |
| W<br>Coords: local   | Animate transform     | E<br>Scale           |
| SW<br>Coords: parent | S<br>Freeze transform | SE<br>Coords: gimbal |

List under the dial: Freeze position · Freeze rotation · Link · Unlink · Select parent · Select child

## Ctrl+Alt+4 Keys

dial 12 - replaces Viewports

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Keys* - file Dials\Packs\Animation - Keys.mfdial

|                    |               |                    |
|--------------------|---------------|--------------------|
| NW<br>Key mode     | N<br>Key all  | NE<br>Key position |
| W<br>Auto Key      | Keys          | E<br>Key rotation  |
| SW<br>Set Key mode | S<br>Set keys | SE<br>Key scale    |

List under the dial: Key pos, rot, scale · Set key selected · Clear Set Key buffer · Create key

## Ctrl+Alt+8 Playback and time

dial 16 - replaces Render

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Playback and time* - file Dials\Packs\Animation - Playback and time.mfdial

|                     |                   |                             |
|---------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------|
| NW<br>Ghosting      | N<br>Play         | NE<br>Next frame            |
| W<br>Previous frame | Playback and time | E<br>Go to end              |
| SW<br>Go to start   | S<br>Motion paths | SE<br>Time configuration... |

List under the dial: SMPTE / frames · Show key times

Shift+Alt+2

## Curves and layers

dial 18 - replaces Animation

Alone, from the dial library: *Animation: Curves and layers* - file `Dials\Packs\Animation - Curves and layers.mfdial`

|                                      |                                   |                                      |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Merge animation...      | <b>N</b><br>Track View            | <b>NE</b><br>Animation layers...     |
| <b>W</b><br>Default tangent: stepped | <b>Curves and layers</b>          | <b>E</b><br>Default tangent: linear  |
| <b>SW</b><br>Reaction manager...     | <b>S</b><br>Default tangent: auto | <b>SE</b><br>Default tangent: smooth |

**List under the dial:** Default tangent: spline · Default tangent: fast · Default tangent: slow · Save animation... · Load animation...

Changes to **Track View** when cursor over Track View.



# LookDev pack

Look development: viewport shading and overrides, light display and shadows, camera controls.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_LookDev.json`

## **Ctrl+Alt+5** Shading

dial 13 - replaces Viewport display

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Shading* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Shading.mfdial`

|                          |                                 |                                 |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Fast shader | <b>N</b><br>Realistic with maps | <b>NE</b><br>Realistic, no maps |
| <b>W</b><br>Override off | <b>Shading</b>                  | <b>E</b><br>Shaded with maps    |
| <b>SW</b><br>Clay        | <b>S</b><br>Default shading     | <b>SE</b><br>UV checker         |

**List under the dial:** Override: render setting · Lit wireframes · Hidden line · Transparency: best · Default / scene lights

## **Shift+Alt+7** Lights

dial 23 - replaces Tools and setup

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Lights* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Lights.mfdial`

|                                   |                            |                                    |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Lock lights          | <b>N</b><br>Light Explorer | <b>NE</b><br>Shadows on            |
| <b>W</b><br>Light view            | <b>Lights</b>              | <b>E</b><br>Default / scene lights |
| <b>SW</b><br>Only selected lights | <b>S</b><br>Hide lights    | <b>SE</b><br>Shadows off           |

**List under the dial:** Unlock lights · Select lighting lights · Select shadow lights · Add default lights · Environment...

## **Shift+Alt+8** Cameras

dial 24 - replaces Lights and cameras

Alone, from the dial library: *LookDev: Cameras* - file `Dials\Packs\LookDev - Cameras.mfdial`

|                            |                          |                                   |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Roll          | <b>N</b><br>Camera view  | <b>NE</b><br>Match camera to view |
| <b>W</b><br>Dolly          | <b>Cameras</b>           | <b>E</b><br>Safe frames           |
| <b>SW</b><br>Field of view | <b>S</b><br>Hide cameras | <b>SE</b><br>Align camera         |

**List under the dial:** Truck · Pan camera · Select camera · Select target · Viewport camera 1 · More cameras...

# Archviz pack

Architectural visualisation and layout: placing, arraying and aligning, snaps, layers and groups, references and files.

File: `Presets\MarkingForge_Pack_Archviz.json`

## **Ctrl+Alt+1** Place and array

dial 9 - replaces Transform

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Place and array* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz - Place and array.mfdial`

|                        |                         |                                 |
|------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Align...  | <b>N</b><br>Place       | <b>NE</b><br>Array...           |
| <b>W</b><br>Clone      | <b>Place and array</b>  | <b>E</b><br>Spacing tool...     |
| <b>SW</b><br>Mirror... | <b>S</b><br>Snapshot... | <b>SE</b><br>Clone and align... |

**List under the dial:** Quick align · Normal align... · Type-in... · + Array modifier

## **Ctrl+Alt+6** Snaps

dial 14 - replaces Snaps and grid

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Snaps* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz - Snaps.mfdial`

|                               |                            |                               |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>AutoGrid         | <b>N</b><br>Snaps          | <b>NE</b><br>Angle snap       |
| <b>W</b><br>Cycle snap type   | <b>Snaps</b>               | <b>E</b><br>Percent snap      |
| <b>SW</b><br>Axis constraints | <b>S</b><br>Snap to frozen | <b>SE</b><br>Snap settings... |

**List under the dial:** Spinner snap · Align grid to view · Hide grids · Grid top · Grid front

## **Shift+Alt+3** Layers and groups

dial 19 - replaces Scene

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: Layers and groups* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz - Layers and groups.mfdial`

|                             |                          |                            |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Scene Explorer | <b>N</b><br>New layer    | <b>NE</b><br>Add to layer  |
| <b>W</b><br>Layer Explorer  | <b>Layers and groups</b> | <b>E</b><br>Select layer   |
| <b>SW</b><br>Freeze layer   | <b>S</b><br>Hide layer   | <b>SE</b><br>Isolate layer |

**List under the dial:** Group · Ungroup · Open group · Close group · Attach to group · Detach from group

Changes to **Scene Explorer** when cursor over the Scene Explorer.

**Shift+Alt+4**

**References and files**

dial 20 - replaces File

Alone, from the dial library: *Archviz: References and files* - file `Dials\Packs\Archviz - References and files.mfdial`

|                              |                             |                              |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>NW</b><br>Summary info... | <b>N</b><br>XRef scene...   | <b>NE</b><br>XRef objects... |
| <b>W</b><br>Save incremental | <b>References and files</b> | <b>E</b><br>Merge...         |
| <b>SW</b><br>Archive...      | <b>S</b><br>Import...       | <b>SE</b><br>Replace...      |

**List under the dial:** Save · Export... · Export selected... · Save selected... · Project paths...

# Make your own pack

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- 1 Arrange the dials you want to share in the editor.
- 2 **Save preset...** writes your layout to one file - without usage data or paths.
- 3 To share only some dials, remove the others from the file in a text editor: a preset replaces exactly the dials it holds (keys "1" to "24" under "menus").
- 4 Scripts in a preset are removed when somebody else loads it, unless they choose **Load WITH the scripts** - wherever they sit: directions, list rows, the tap item, submenus and variants. Prefer 3ds Max commands for anything you share.

A preset holds what each dial shows, with that dial's own colours - not a dial's other sets (the pages under the mouse wheel) and not the colours set for every dial. Two other ways to share:

- **One dial: Save dial...**, or right-click the dial > **Save Menu N (...) to a file...** - a `.mfdial` file, loaded with **Load dial...** in place of a dial or as a new set of it.
- **Everything: Save every dial...** writes every dial and every set to a dated folder, with the colours of every dial; **Load every dial...** puts it all back. Scripts in these files are removed on loading too, unless the person loading them keeps them.
- **A colour look to go with it: Colours... > Presets > Export this preset to a file...** (a `.mfcolors` file; **Import a preset from a file...** on the other side).

# Support, bug reports and feature requests

|        |                                                                                                                    |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ISSUES | <a href="https://github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues">github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues</a>              |
| E-MAIL | <a href="mailto:forgeplugins@gmail.com">forgeplugins@gmail.com</a>                                                 |
| WEB    | <a href="https://forgeplugins.tech">https://forgeplugins.tech</a> (forgeplugins.tech - more plugins by the author) |

**Bug reports and feature requests** are best opened as issues on GitHub - the forms there ask for exactly what is needed, and you can follow the fix. Questions, and anything you would rather not post publicly (licence, purchase), go to the e-mail address. Every message is read.

## Reporting a bug

- 1 In 3ds Max choose **MarkingForge > Report a bug...** - it copies your 3ds Max version, MarkingForge version, configuration summary and start-up log to the clipboard. It works even when the plugin did not load.
- 2 Open [github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues](https://github.com/looki666/MarkingForge/issues) and pick **Bug report** - or answer **Yes** in the dialog to write an e-mail to [forgeplugins@gmail.com](mailto:forgeplugins@gmail.com) instead.
- 3 Say what you did, what you expected and what happened instead, then paste the details with **Ctrl+V**.
- 4 Add a screenshot if you can. When the problem is in one dial, attach a preset of it (editor > **Save preset...**).

## Suggesting a feature

Open an issue with the **Feature request** form, choose **MarkingForge > Suggest a feature...**, or simply write. Describe what you would like to do and how you do it today - a concrete example from your work says more than a list of wishes. Ideas for new built-in dials, commands and options are all welcome.

Nothing is sent by the plugin itself: the details go to the clipboard and your own e-mail program, so you see everything that leaves your computer. MarkingForge has no network access.